

Price watch

We list the latest prices for smartphones, desktop and laptop RAM modules and portable speakers

Killer Rigs

Thinking of putting together a new rig? We've got you covered across different budgets. Take a look at our Killer Rigs.

Cabinet conundrum

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Here at Digit, most of us are constantly experimenting with something or the other which is why many of us don't use a cabinet for our rigs. It's not as if we don't like them, rather not having one helps with swapping components on a regular basis.

It all started when Mithun came to the office with a sullen look on his face. And when Siddharth probed him with his favourite question – “What ails you?” He replied saying that when he went home the previous night from work, he found that he couldn't access one of the internal hard drives connected to his PC. He'd kept one of the drives outside the cabinet for want of space and a little accident with an open bottle of water led to 500 GB of data going up in smoke, literally.

This is why, we all – at least the ones who didn't have a cabinet or had one but it wasn't good enough (including myself), decided that we should join him and go and buy new one. Siddharth, Siddhant, Mithun and I decided that we should pay Lamington Road a visit for new cases.

After we reached the place, we went inside a couple of known shops and started looking for available options. Since Mithun was using a pretty beefy system at home with an ATX board, a full-size GPU, an AIO liquid cooler and multiple hard drives, he wanted to go for a full-tower case under ₹15K which would provide him more space for future upgrades. Siddharth wanted a replacement for his ageing Zebronics Bijli so he wanted to buy something that's feature-rich, looks



Optimal Airflow in a case

good and is a mid-tower between ₹6k to 7k. Siddhant wanted a mid-tower and I needed a mini-ITX case for my HTPC. We decided on a budget of not more than ₹2.5K for the HTPC case and about 4K for the mid-tower.

What YOU should look for when buying a PC case

The stuff that anyone should consider before buying a PC cabinet are the kind of components that they're going to install, primarily the dimensions of these components. You should then consider whether you want a case for a mini-ITX, micro-ATX, ATX or an E-ATX board and also keep in mind the number of components that it should be able to house. This isn't a hard and fast rule given that you can even buy a full-tower case for a micro-ATX based system, like if you're planning to

After having postponed getting cabinets for quite some time, members of Team Digit finally go on a PC case shopping spree

mod this case into a beautiful piece of art.

Airflow is of prime importance when you're buying a new cabinet. It is often overlooked by quite a lot of system builders and it is a terrible thing to do. Components inside a system need cool air so that they can run without hiccups and starving parts like CPU and GPU of air, results in them running at high temperatures which in turn decreases their overall life-span. A good case should take cool air from the front and bottom and expel warm air from the rear and top. To do this, a case should have enough number of

intake and exhaust fans. It's often better to have more exhaust fans than intake fans as this would result in negative air pressure inside the case and there would be less stagnant warm air inside the case. Although negative pressure provides the best level of cooling, there is a higher chance of dust settling inside the case. Which is why dust filters are always a welcome feature. Also, if the case has tall feet then it helps by decreasing the amount of dust that can be sucked in from beneath the case.

Other important stuff that you should look for when buying a case are:

- Selecting the right size of the case depending upon your components, especially tall air coolers or even a liquid cooler with a big radiator;
- Whether the particular case in question has enough drive bays;